

Jim Crane

Onchain Artist & Creative Technologist | Founder, Xtrata & Audionals

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PROFILE

Artist, creative technologist and sound engineer building permanent, verifiable systems for on-chain art and music. My practice uses blockchain as both medium and archive: origin material such as loops, stems, credits, metadata, code, interviews and project histories becomes part of the work rather than hidden production residue. Since 2014, I have developed Bitcoin and Stacks projects spanning recursive media, provenance, rights, preservation, public research archives and AI-assisted creative workflows.

PRACTICE FOCUS

On-chain creation | Provenance and source material | Creative archives and cultural memory | Rights and re-use | Human and machine authorship | Generative audio and sound installation

SELECTED ONCHAIN & CREATIVE TECHNOLOGY WORK

Founder and Developer | Xtrata / Forever Twins | 2026-present

- Created Xtrata, an inscription-based data layer on Stacks for permanent, fully on-chain generative art and programmable cultural records.
- Created Forever Twins, giving existing NFT collections permanent, hash-verified twins inscribed on Bitcoin via Stacks so their artwork survives failed off-chain links.
- Awarded a Stacks Community DeGrants Cohort 4 grant; launched the first public collection, Bitcoin Pepes, with holders already claiming twins.
- Built XTRATA FM, an on-chain radio widget that streams multi-megabyte tracks directly from inscriptions.

Founder | Audionals | 2023-present

- Developed a protocol for producing, storing and rights-managing music directly on Bitcoin, treating stems, credits, provenance and reusable components as native parts of the work.
- Released TRUTH, the first recursive music collection on Bitcoin; the collection sold out in just over an hour.
- Used recursive references to reduce the incremental inscription data for tracks derived from roughly 70 MB of music to around 3 KB per track, making fully on-chain music economically viable within Bitcoin's block-size limits.
- Developing KP Loops with Kieron Pepper (The Prodigy), an on-chain drum-loop library designed around traceable source material and re-use.

Creator, Host and Producer | The Audionals Show | 2023-present

- Created a long-form interview and discussion series on on-chain music, sound design and creative technology within the Bitcoin ecosystem.
- Built a public research archive through 40+ episodes, leading concept development, guest curation, technical production and documentation.

Co-founder | This Is Number One | 2021

- Co-founded the first NFT marketplace on the Stacks blockchain, debuting the network's first commercial and music NFT collections.
- Collaborators included Fatboy Slim, Orbital, Cara Delevingne, Dave Stewart (Eurythmics) and Chemical X.

Creative Technologist | AI and Audio Workflow Systems | 2024-present

- Designed automation tools that reduced a publisher's audiobook production workflow from roughly 8 hours to 6 minutes, translating unstructured text and media tasks into repeatable pipelines.
- Use AI systems for research, prototyping, editing, compression and media structuring, with attention to authorship, traceability and human judgement.

SELECTED INSTALLATION & SOUND DESIGN

Sound and Lighting Designer / Technician | THEY / ONLAR by Ipek Duben, Fabrica Gallery | 2017

- Designed and deployed directional speaker systems, multi-zone playback and sensor-driven interactivity for an immersive sound installation.

Audio System Designer and Lead PA Engineer | Stories in Motion / Longrange, Brighton Festival | 2006

- Designed and implemented a quadraphonic PA configuration for a performance featuring Irvine Welsh and Longrange.

PROFESSIONAL TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

Sound Engineer and Technician | Brighton Dome & Festival | 2002-present

- Deliver sound, stage and technical support across music, theatre, dance, comedy, festivals and outdoor arts, realising complex work with visiting artists and production companies.

Tour Manager, Front of House and Monitor Engineer | Freelance | 2006-2019

- Managed international tours and led crews of up to 15 for artists including Palma Violets, The Go! Team, The Big Moon, Kelis and Tom Waits.

Monitor Engineer | Krankenhaus Festival, Muncaster | 2025

- Provided monitor engineering and stage sound management for the multi-day independent arts and music festival founded by Sea Power.

Additional Selected Production Credits | BBC, ITV, Glastonbury Festival, Brighton Festival | 2002-2012

- Moving light technician for Later... with Jools Holland and The Jonathan Ross Show; stage crew on Glastonbury's Jazz World / One World stage; audio system designer and lead PA engineer for a quadraphonic Brighton Festival project featuring Irvine Welsh and Longrange.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

- Diploma in Audio Engineering - School of Audio Engineers, Sydney, Australia
- Diploma in Performing Arts - The Actors Centre, Sydney, Australia
- Ongoing self-directed study in blockchain development, AI-assisted production, generative audio, inscriptions, creative metadata and decentralised cultural infrastructure.

SELECTED MILESTONES

- Imported the UK's first two-way Bitcoin ATM in 2014, beginning a long-term engagement with decentralised systems.
- Helped pioneer the first NFTs on Stacks in 2021 and establish early models for Bitcoin-adjacent creative publishing.

LINKS

Audionals: <https://audionals.com> | KP Loops: <https://audionals.com/BAM/kp-loops>

X / Twitter: <https://x.com/jimdotbtc> | Stacks identity: jim.btc